Michael "Fitz" Fitzgerald

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Senior Frontend Engineer | React • Accessibility • Federal Modernization

I build production React applications for federal agencies and enterprise systems. 20+ years shipping accessible, maintainable frontends, from HRSA's multi-site Angular platform to CPSC's internal modernization system. Specialized in 508 compliance implementation, legacy system refactoring, and translating complex stakeholder requirements into clean, scalable code. My unique combination of frontend engineering depth and UX sensibility means I build systems that are both technically sound and genuinely usable.

Core Technical Skills

- **Frontend Engineering:** React, Angular, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript
- Styling & Architecture: SASS, responsive design, component libraries, design systems
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.1 AA/AAA implementation, 508 compliance, ARIA, screen reader testing (JAWS), WAVE, aXe, Lighthouse
- **Tools & Workflow:** Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, Jira, Agile/Scrum, CI/CD pipelines
- **Federal/Enterprise:** Security compliance, legacy modernization, stakeholder management, public trust clearance
- **Additional Capabilities:** UX prototyping (Figma, Axure), Graphic design (Illustrator, Photoshop), Firebase, Node.js, Express, SQLite, WordPress plugin development

Professional Experience

Senior Frontend Engineer (Contract) • 2025–Present

Meshperanto — 2026

- Word-level Huffman codec for LoRa mesh networks, compressing natural language messages by 1.5–2.5x. Open-source library with React playground for live testing.
- **Tech:** TypeScript, Node.js, React

QuestRex Backstoryr — 2026

- Hybrid AI backstory generator combining structured user input with LLM narrative generation. Users can regenerate sections independently without losing the full thread.
- **Tech:** React, xAI API, WordPress

QuoDrox — 2026

- Landing page and waitlist system for a product in development, architected from the start for a clean Shopify migration when the product launches.
- Tech: HTML, SCSS, Liquid templates, MailerLite

Dash's of Old Town — 2026

- Static site for a bespoke menswear shop built with a unified fluid typography and spacing system that scales seamlessly across viewports.
- **Tech:** HTML, SCSS, Liquid templates

Squirl! — 2025

- Refactored an AI-assisted prototype into a production-ready mobile social app, including UX consultation and full component architecture rebuild.
- **Tech:** React, SASS, Figma, Replit

urAtlas Odyssey — 2025

- Full-stack accountability platform for life coaches with React frontend, real-time dashboards, and an Express/SQLite backend with RESTful API architecture and Firebase authentication.
- **Tech:** React, Express, SQLite, Firebase, Node.js, Figma

QuestRex Character Generator — 2024

- Complex React app managing 50+ interconnected character creation fields with cascading dependencies, packaged as a WordPress plugin.
- **Tech:** React, SASS, WordPress Plugin API

Publicis Sapient • Senior Frontend Engineer • 2013–2024

Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) — 2019–2024

- Production React application modernizing legacy internal workflows for a federal agency. WCAG 2.1 AA and Section 508 compliance implemented across 40+ custom components using JAWS, NVDA, and WAVE screen reader and accessibility testing baked in from the start, not bolted on later. Unit testing (Jest).
- **Tech:** React, SASS, Axure, JAWS/NVDA/WAVE, Section 508, Jest

HRSA Health Workforce Connector — 2016–2019

- Accessibility-compliant component library and UX patterns deployed across 5+ federal healthcare websites. Built Angular from beta through production surviving multiple framework rewrites. Full WCAG and Section 508 compliance throughout.
- **Tech:** Angular, SASS, TypeScript, Axure, WAVE, Section 508

PenFed Credit Union — 2013–2016

- CSS architecture and cross-platform styling for a hybrid mobile banking app ensuring visual consistency across iOS, Android, and legacy devices.
- **Tech:** PhoneGap (Cordova), HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript

Education & Additional Information

- **Education:** BA, Communications – Old Dominion University
- **Clearance:** U.S. Citizen, have held multiple public trust clearances, open to clearance sponsorship
- **References:** Available upon request